

TRUSTMRR · 1,000 VERIFIED BUSINESSES · FROZEN 30 JULY 2026

The Exit Hatch

A market that prices the past.

A quarter of these businesses are for sale. The market that prices them can't see growth. And the people selling are the ones who've stopped growing.

1,000

verified businesses

262

for sale · 26.2%

218

priced with real revenue

PRESENTED BY Raghav Dua

AI in Business I

Revenue here is checked at the source

TrustMRR reads each company's payment processor through an API key. The money is verified by the processor, not typed in by the founder. That's rare for indie-startup data. It's why the rest of this analysis is worth anything.

1,000 rows

29 variables

cross-sectional snapshot

no time dimension

THREE LAYERS, THREE LEVELS OF TRUST

Verified financials

~100%

revenue, MRR, subscriptions, growth · payment-processor API



Self-described profile

65–72%

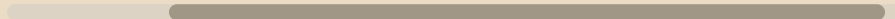
value prop, persona, pricing, category · founder-entered



Third-party enrichment

18–98%

domain rating, visitors, followers · SEO and traffic tools



Most of these aren't businesses

Median MRR

\$282**48x gap**

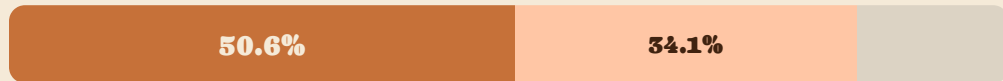
Mean MRR

\$13,472

The average is 48 times the middle. When a mean runs that far ahead of the median, a handful of companies hold nearly everything.

Share of all 12-month revenue

1,000 companies



Top 1%

Next 9% → 84.7%

Bottom 90%

The bottom of the board

216

earned nothing in the last 30 days · 21.6%

101

have never earned a single dollar

162

fully dormant: zero revenue, MRR, subscribers

59.1%

make under \$1,000 a month

The better businesses are the ones on the block

26.2%

262 of 1,000 are listed for sale. This isn't a distressed dump. The stronger businesses are the ones leaving.

16.8%

of sellers are dead,
vs 23.3% of everyone
else

Sellers

Everyone else

Median MRR

Sellers

\$1,055

5.6×

\$187

Median 12-month revenue

\$7,967

\$2,416

Median subscribers

32

11

Medians. Sellers n=262, everyone else n=738. Bars scaled within each metric.

Every price rests on a single month

$$\text{multiple} = \text{asking price} \div \text{last 30 days of revenue} \times 12$$

This month $\times 12$ reconstructs the platform's own stated multiple

87.6%

match to one decimal
93.5% to whole
numbers · n=217

Trailing twelve months, the intuitive guess, matches

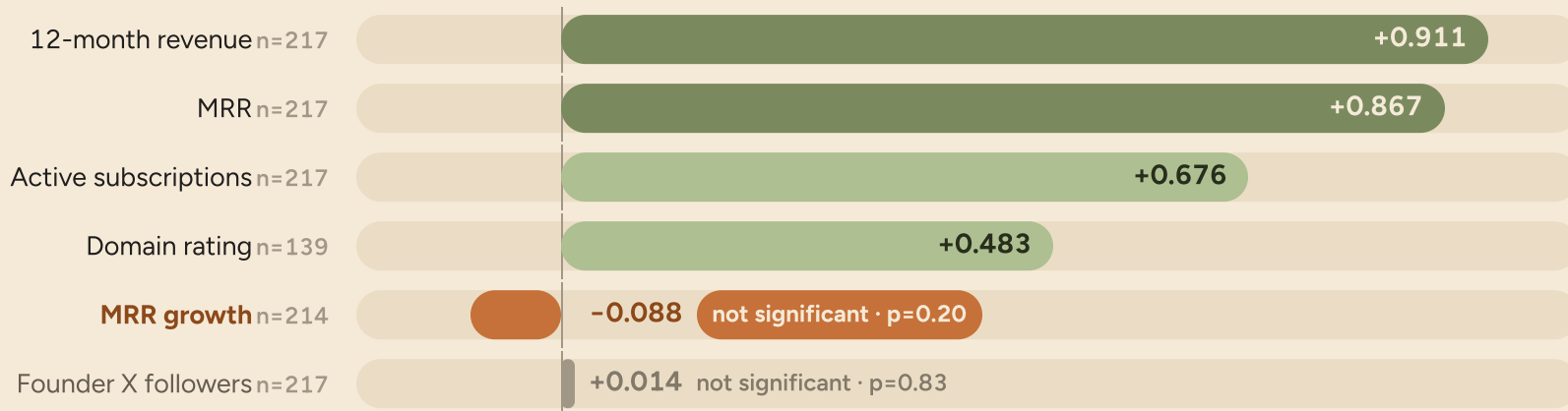
1.8%

Assume TTM and
you misprice
every listing.

The whole market runs on 30 days of data. n=217 listings with both a price and a stated multiple.

Growth is priced at zero

What the asking price actually moves with. Spearman's rank correlation, revenue-positive listings.



In venture, growth *is* the valuation. Here it's the one thing the price ignores. The market pays for what happened, not what's happening.

I tested the obvious explanation. It reversed.

HYPOTHESIS

~~If the price comes from one month, sellers will list on a strong month.~~

Rejected

It goes the other way. Sellers are running *behind* their own annual pace, not ahead of it.

Non-sellers

Sellers

Current month vs annual pace $p=0.012$

+42% ahead

+12%

Mean MRR growth $p=0.005$

41.9%

10.1%

Share still growing

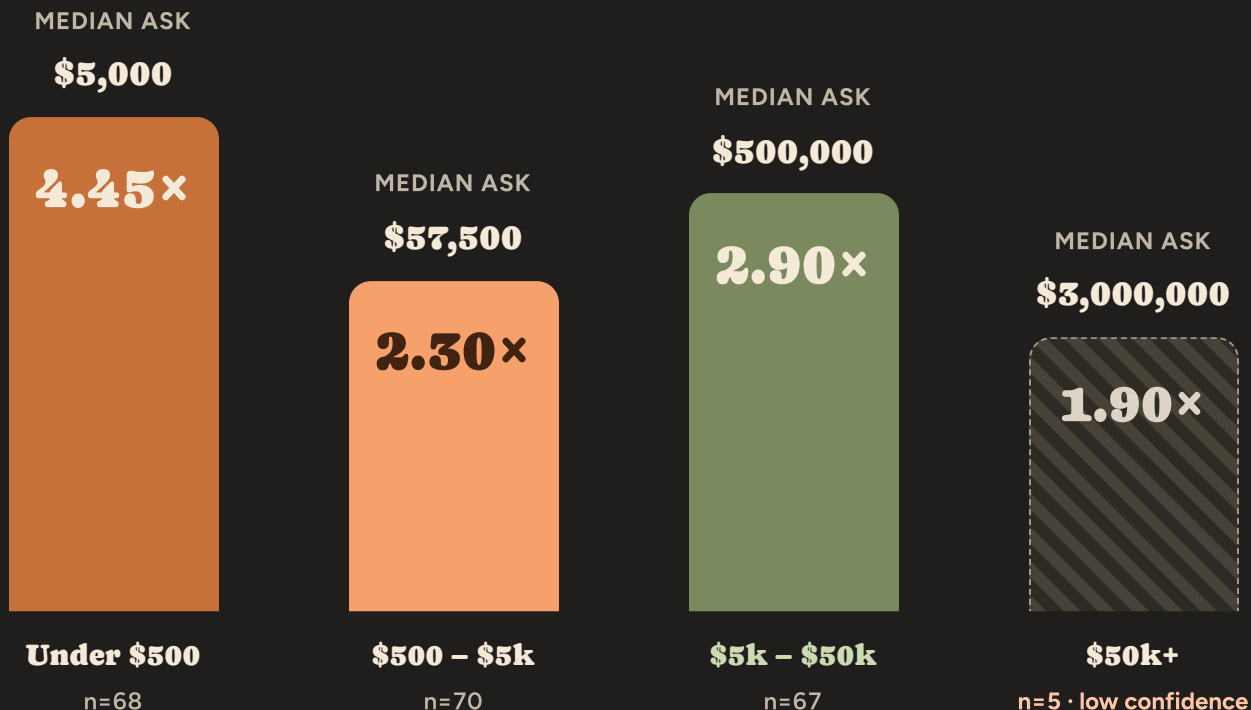
33.0%

24.6%

People list when the curve flattens. The buyer pays a multiple of peak run-rate on a business that's already rolled over.

The smallest sellers ask the most

Spearman's rho = -0.19 · p = 0.005



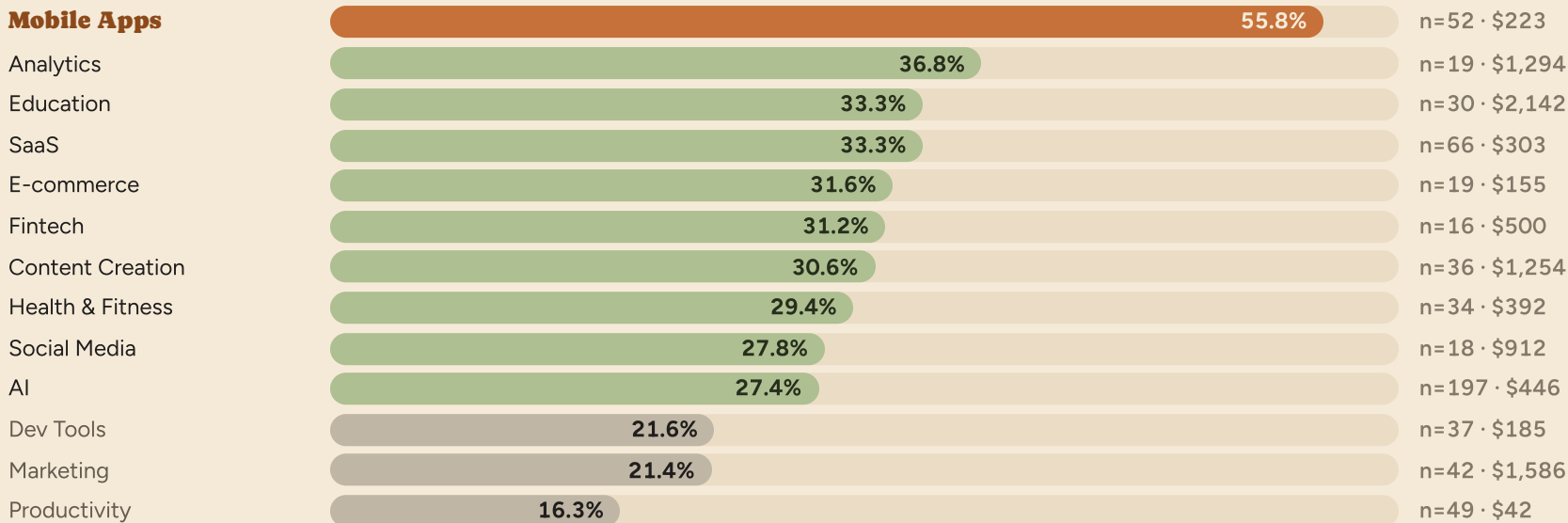
Hobby projects priced like assets. Real businesses priced like exits. The bars fall as the ask climbs from \$5k to \$3M.

Bar height is median asking multiple. Median asking price shown above each bar. The \$50k+ bar rests on 5 listings.

Over half of all mobile apps are for sale

Share of category listed for sale.
Green sits above the 26.2% market rate.

Mobile Apps

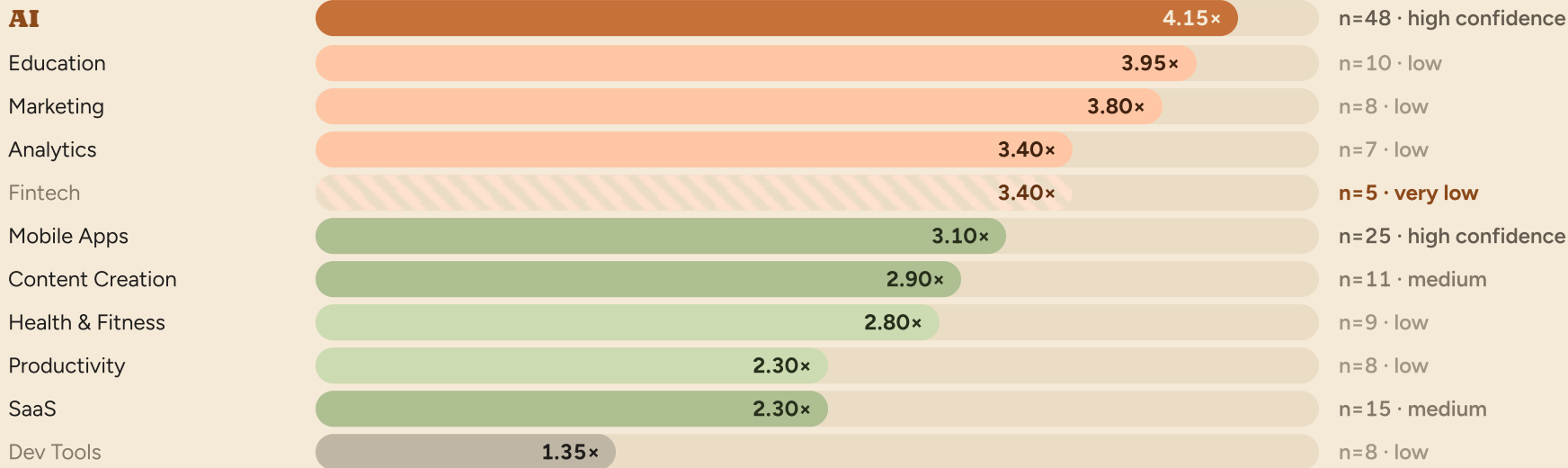


Categories with $n \geq 15$. Trailing figure is median MRR. Mobile Apps capitulate at a \$223 median.

Buyers pay a premium for the word AI

Median asking multiple by category.

Faded bars rest on small samples.



AI carries a narrative premium on the largest, most reliable sample here, 4.15× against a 2.90× market median, despite mid-table revenue. Buyers are paying for the noun.

A sixth of the market earns nothing

44

listings with zero revenue in the last 30 days · 16.8% of the market

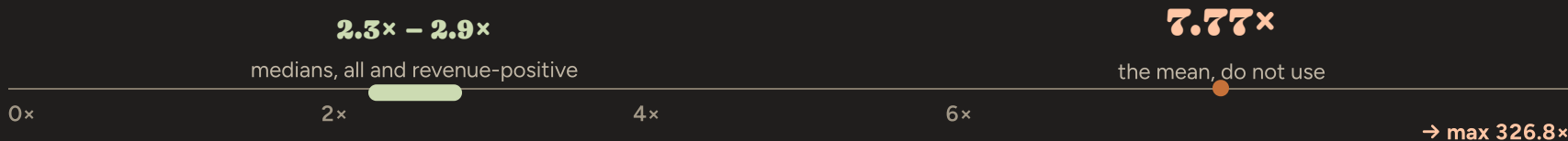
47

listings priced at a multiple of exactly 0.0×

\$2,750

median ask for a listing that currently earns nothing

This is why every figure in this deck is a median. Watch what the outliers do to a mean.



All pricing cuts use medians on revenue-positive listings only. The mean is shown here to be discredited.

Buy the boring middle, avoid the story

Buy 2.90×

\$5k to \$50k MRR, still growing, in an unglamorous category.

The one cohort where the revenue is real and the multiple isn't inflated. Boring is the whole point.

Avoid

4.45× sub-\$500 MRR, an asset price on a hobby project

4.15× anything labelled AI, that's the narrative premium



any listing where the pricing month wildly outruns the annual pace

The edge

The market can't price growth. If you can, you're the only person in the room who can.

What this data can't tell you

Naming the edges out loud is what separates an analyst from a spreadsheet. None of these break the findings. All of them bound them.

Asking prices, not sales

No closed prices exist here. Every number is seller intent. Real sales usually land below ask, so read each figure as an asking multiple.

Stale inventory could explain the curve

What's left on the board is what didn't sell. Small sellers may still be visible because nobody paid 4.45x, not because they're worth it.

Correlation, not cause

There's no founding or listing date. "Listed because growth stalled" and "stalled because it's mature" can't be told apart. Sellers are flatter. That's all we can say.

Some samples are tiny

A few category multiples rest on a handful of rows. Fintech is five. Sample size sits on every chart for a reason. Concede the small ones first.

One platform, one day

TrustMRR only, frozen 30 July. Founders who verify revenue by API key are self-selected. This is "this market," not the whole micro-acquisition world.

A supply-side snapshot

No listing dates, no outcomes, no buyers, no time axis. How long they sit, what fraction sell, who buys, whether it's growing: each needs a second dataset.